TikTok Fact Checking

Overview

TikTok

Welcome to the TikTok Fact-Checking Program!



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Global TikTok Fact Checking Partnerships - Quick Overview

60+
Markets

30+
Languages

14 Fact Checking Partners

AFP
THOMSON REUTERS
ANIMAL POLITICO
ESTADÃO VERIFICA
Logically
Newtral
Science Feedback
teyit
dpa
newschecker.in
Facta
POLITIFACT
LEAD STORIES
aap

122,000+
Fact Checked Claims

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TikTok's Approach to Misinformation

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TikTok's Approach to Misinformation

TikTok

https://www.tiktok.com/community-guidelines

Introduction

Minor Safety

Dangerous acts and challenges

Suicide, self-harm, and disordered eating

Adult nudity and sexual activities

Bullying and harassment

Hateful behavior

Violent extremism

Integrity and authenticity

Illegal activities and regulated goods

Violent and graphic content

Copyright and trademark infringement

Platform security

Harmful misinformation

Misinformation is defined as content that is inaccurate or false. We will remove misinformation that causes significant harm to individuals, our community, or the larger public regardless of intent. Significant harm includes serious physical injury, illness, or death; severe psychological trauma; large-scale property damage, and the undermining of public trust in civic institutions and processes such as governments, elections, and scientific bodies. This does not include simply inaccurate information, myths, or commercial or reputational harm.

Do not post, upload, stream, or share:

- Misinformation that incites hate or prejudice
- Misinformation related to emergencies that induces panic
- Medical misinformation that can cause harm to an individual's physical health
- Content that misleads community members about elections or other civic processes
- Conspiratorial content including content that attacks a specific person or a protected group, includes a violent call to action, or denies a violent or tragic event occurred
- Digital Forgeries (Synthetic Media or Manipulated Media) that mislead users by distorting the truth of events and cause significant harm to the subject of the video, other persons, or society

Do not:

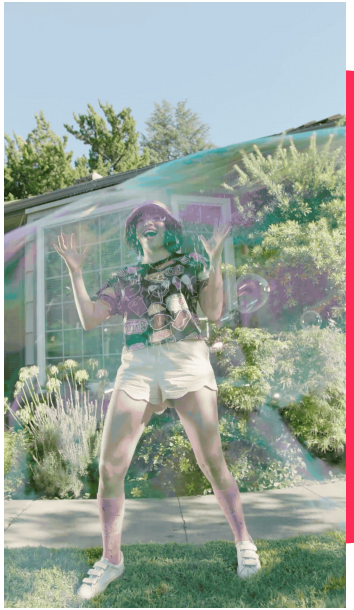
- Engage in coordinated inauthentic behavior such as the use of multiple accounts to exert influence and sway public opinion while misleading individuals, our community, or our systems about the

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TikTok's Approach to Misinformation

We believe that trust forms the foundation of our community. We do not allow activities that may undermine the integrity or authenticity of our platform or our users.

We **remove** content or accounts that involve spam or fake engagement, impersonation, or **misleading information that causes harm**.

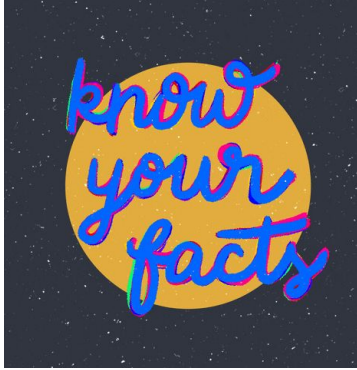


We define misinformation as content that is inaccurate or false.

While we encourage our community to have conversations about subjects that matter to them, we **do not permit misinformation that causes harm** to individuals, our community, or the larger public **regardless of intent.**

Overview of the Misinformation Workflow

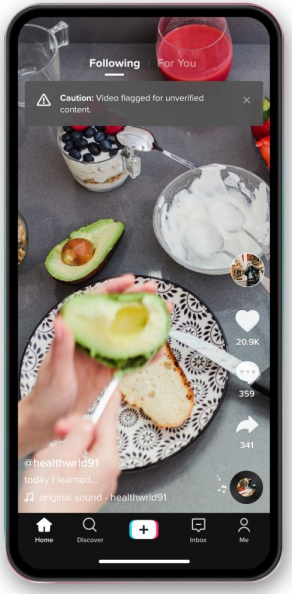
User Facing Interventions - Know The Facts

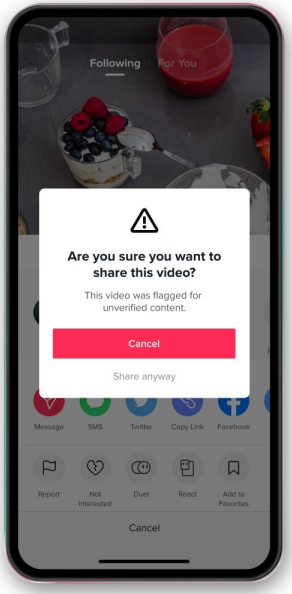


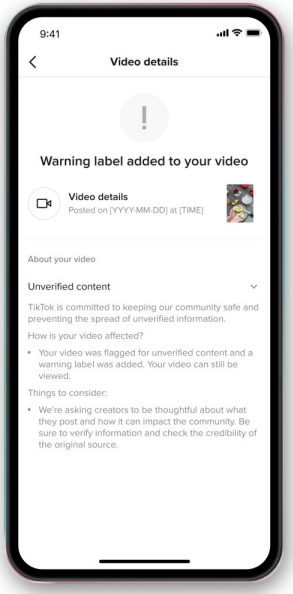
Know The Facts

If **fact-checking** is **inconclusive** due to **unfolding events**, we will:

1. Limit the distribution of content into anyone's For You feed to reduce the potential for misinformation to spread.
2. Inform viewers when we identify a video with unsubstantiated content in an effort to reduce sharing.



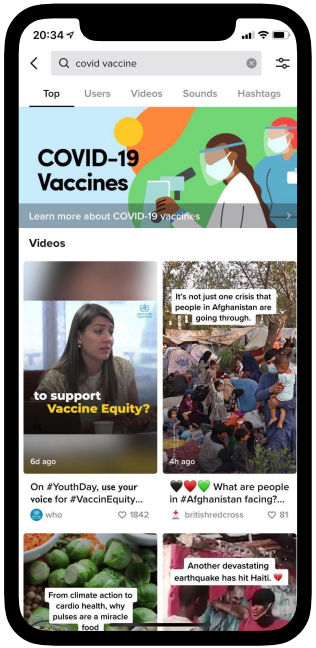


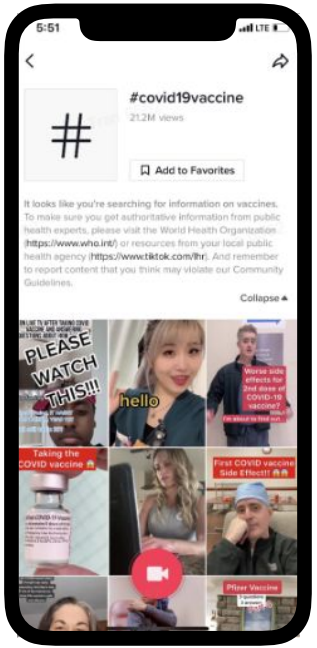


Overview of the Misinformation Workflow

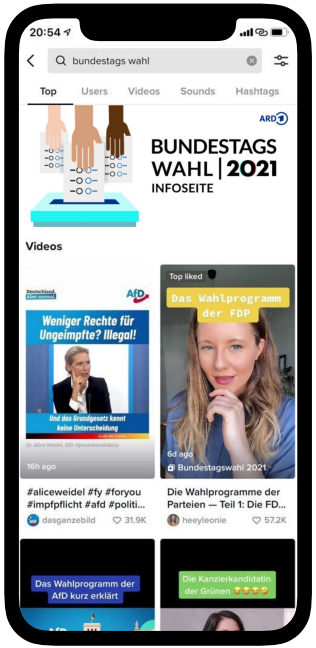
User Facing Interventions - Elevate Trusted Sources









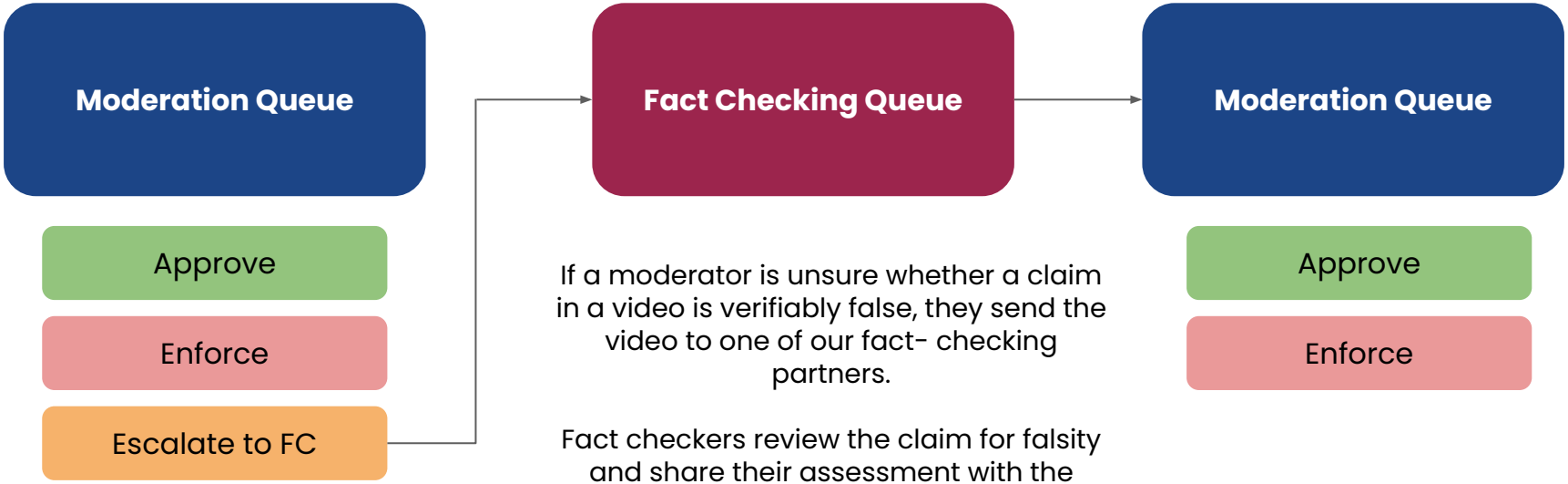


COVID-19 | Elections

Notice Tags	Search Banners	Hashtag PSA	Media literacy	Search Banners & Hub

Process Flow

We rely on our fact checking partners as experts to help our moderation teams assess whether a video includes misinformation that violates TikTok's Community Guidelines.



How TikTok Uses Fact-Checker Assessments

1. **Determine whether content violates TikTok's misinformation policies:** TikTok moderators and policy team use the categories and sub-classifications that fact-checkers select to determine whether the content violates TikTok's misinformation policies and should be removed from recommendation feeds or removed from the platform.

2. **Track trends:** We rely heavily on fact-checkers to help us track misinformation trends across languages and markets and understand how we can bolster our systems to address them.

3. **Identify policy gaps:** We leverage fact-checker insights to help understand whether there might be gaps in our misinformation policies or procedures preventing us from addressing harmful misinformation.

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Steps to Fact Check Content on TikTok



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Step 1: Download Lark

LARK

- Lark is a communications tool similar to Slack, Google Chat and Microsoft Teams.
- Partners will need to download and login to Lark, in order to communicate with the TikTok team and access the fact-checking tool.

- Please send us the list of names, along with emails addresses and location for us to send them a Lark invite.

- They will need to download and login to Lark using their email address.

Step 2: Download TCS

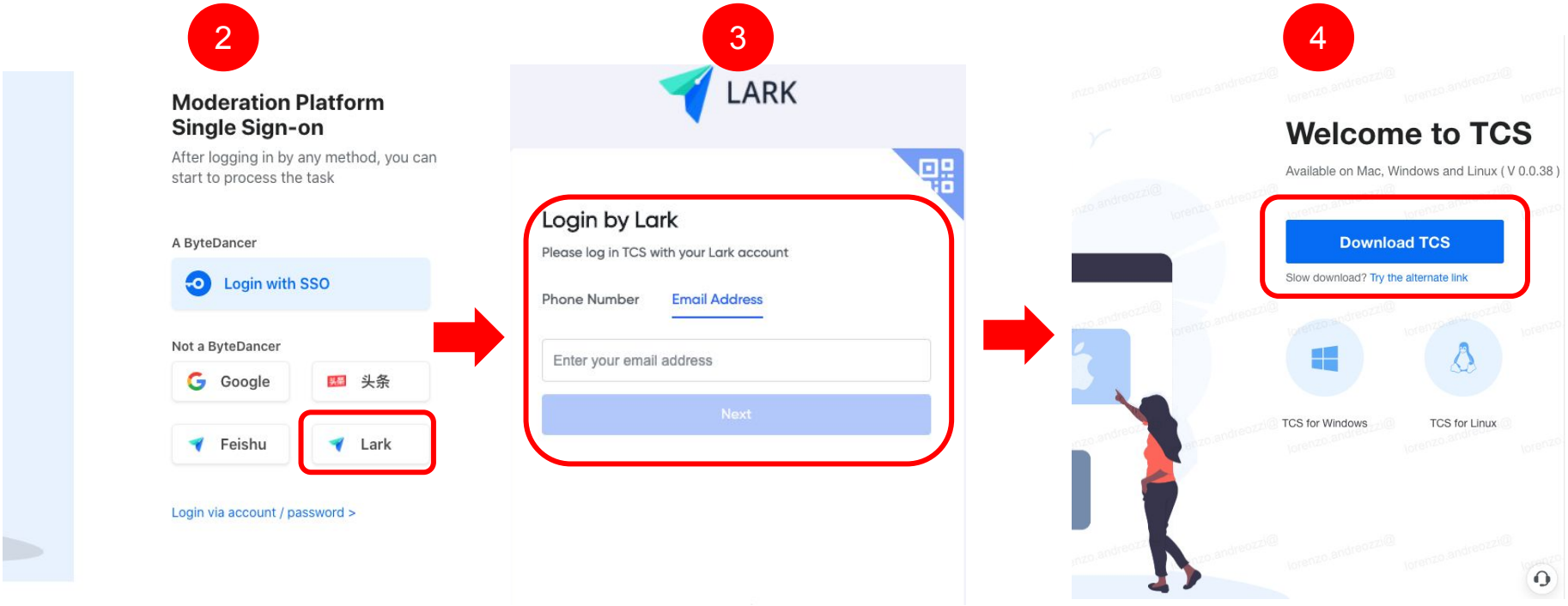


Task Crowdsourcing

- TCS (Task Crowdsourcing) is an internal TikTok tool used by both the moderation and fact checking teams.
- This will be the primary tool to fact checking content on TikTok.

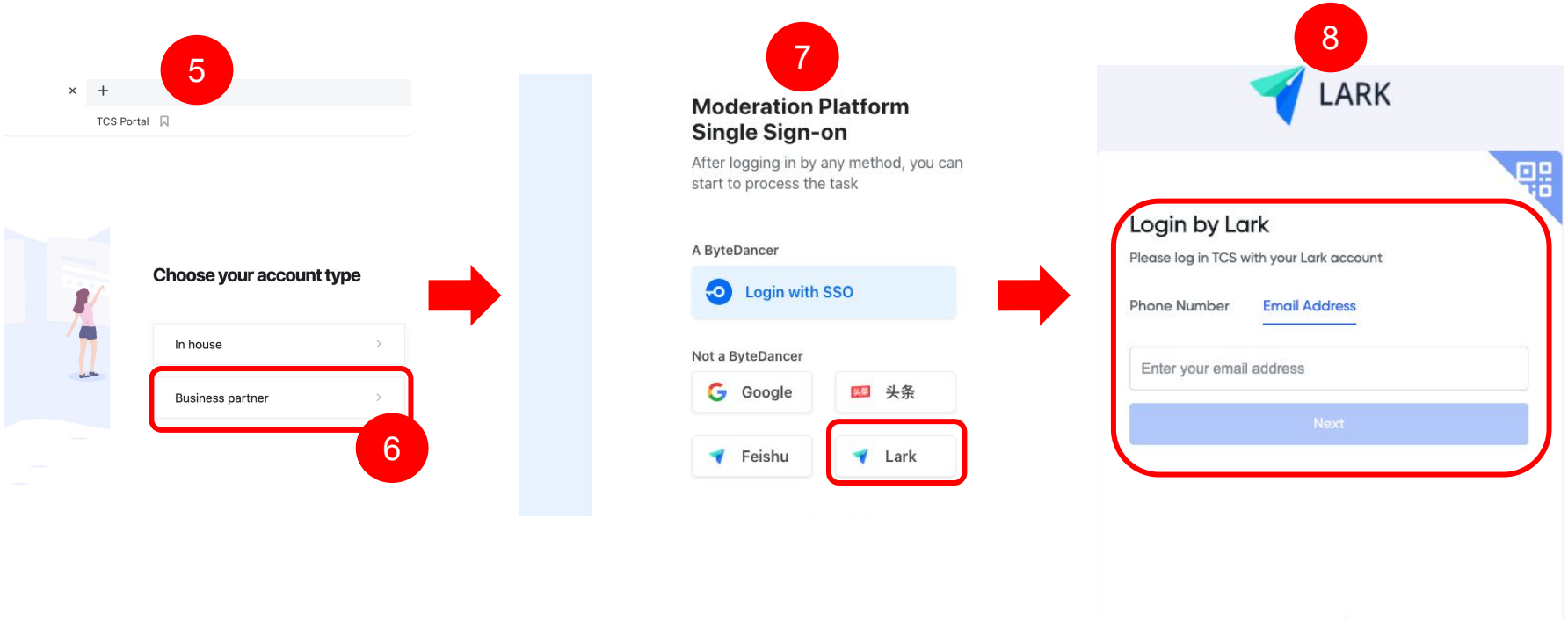
Step 2: Download TCS

1. Copy and paste this url to the search bar of your browser: https://tcs-sg.bytelemon.com/worktable/download
2. Select “Feishu” or “Lark”; after that you’ll be redirected to a login page
3. When you are in the login page, use your credentials to access the download app page
4. Click on “Download TCS” and install the app (full instruction for installation will be provided)

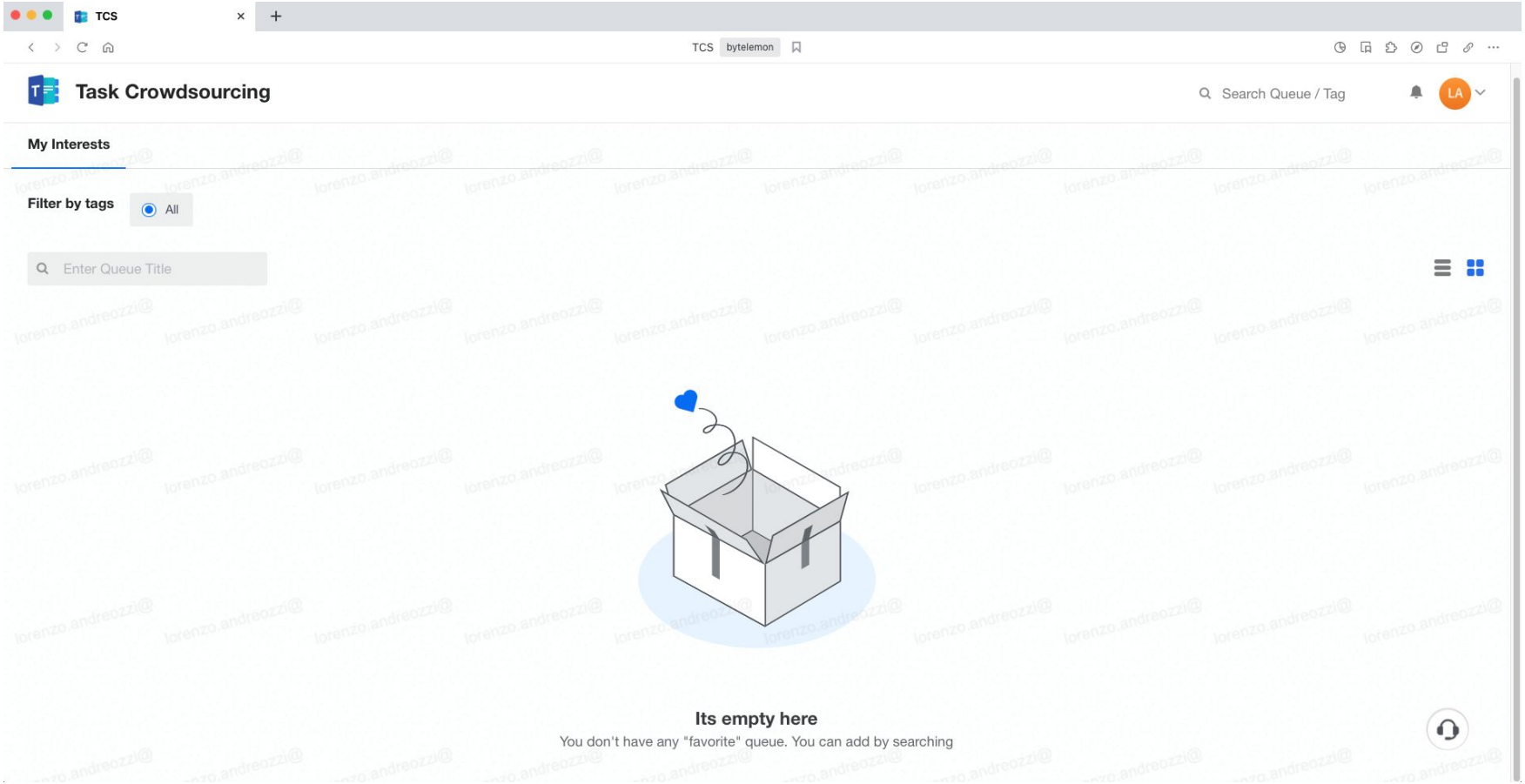


Step 3: Login to TCS

1. Once you have installed the app, open it and you will see the “Choose your account type” landing page
2. Select “Business partner”
3. Select “Lark”; after that you’ll be redirected to a login page
4. When you are in the login page use your credentials to access the TCS platform



Welcome to TCS!



Step 4: Pin Queues

1. Search the queue in TCS by entering the queue name or queue ID in the search bar (top right)



2. Select “Search” and you will find the queue; at this point click on the “star” beside the queue name



3. Go back to the homepage and you will see the queue displayed on your homepage



Step 5: Start Fact Checking!

Select “Moderate” to fact-check content in the queue; click “View” to check content in the queue



TCS Fact Checking Overview



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Fact Checking Queue

VIDEO INFO

Caption	caption:
Create Time	2022-09-16 10:06:59
VV	3384
Share	23

Claim in the Video

Enter a sentence explaining the claim in the video that you are debunking. For example: '5G is harmful to humans' or 'Vaccines cause autism'

Notes

Explain the reasoning for why you chose the categories on the right

URL

Include any links that support your decision

Gray Mode



General Classification *

- (•) Misinformation
- ( ) Unconfirmed/Disputed
- ( ) Not Misinformation
- ( ) Nothing to Fact-Check

Sub Classification *

- [ ] COVID-19 Vaccine
- [ ] Other Vaccine
- [ ] COVID-19
- [ ] Other Medical
- [ ] Crisis
- [ ] Election
- [ ] Political
- [ ] Edited Media
- [ ] Climate
- [ ] Dangerous Conspiracy Theory
- [ ] Financial
- [ ] General Conspiracy Theory
- [ ] Other

Rating Classifications

New

VIDEO INFO

Caption	test text test text test text test text test text test t ext test text test text test text test text test text tex
Create Time	test text test text
VV	0
Share	0

Claim in the Video

Enter a sentence explaining the claim in the video that you are debunking. For example: '5G is harmful to humans' or 'Vaccines cause autism'

Notes

Explain the reasoning for why you chose the categories on the right

URL

Include any links that support your decision



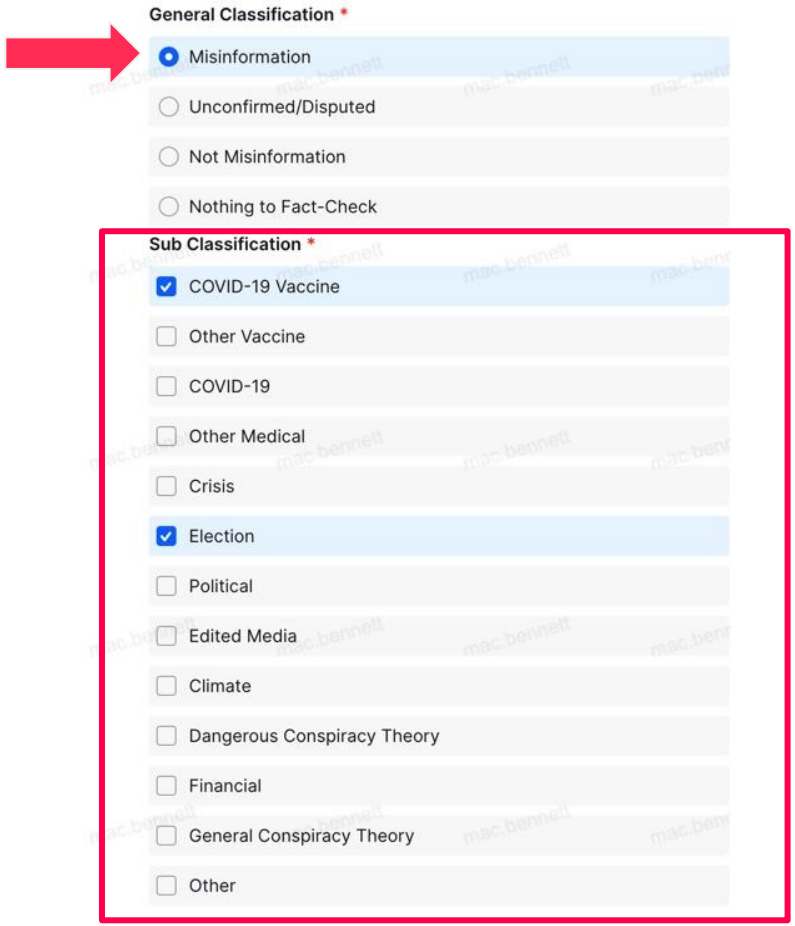
General Classification *

- ○ Misinformation
- ○ Unconfirmed/Disputed
- ○ Not Misinformation
- ○ Nothing to Fact-Check

Required

Sub-Classifications

New

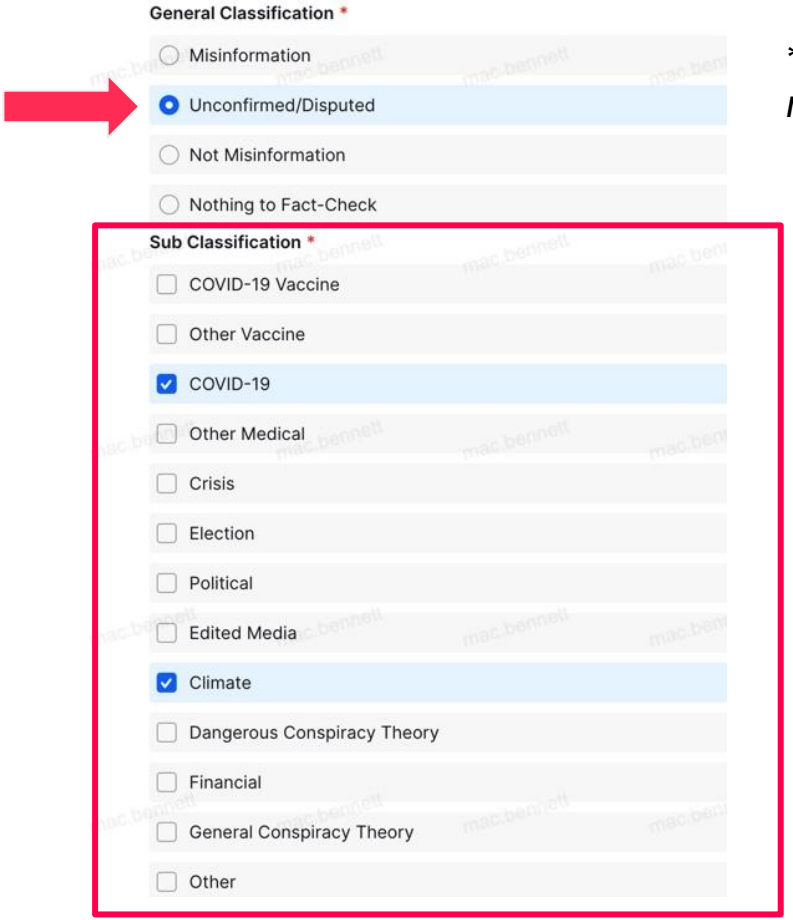


**Sub-classifications are multi-select*

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Sub-Classifications

New

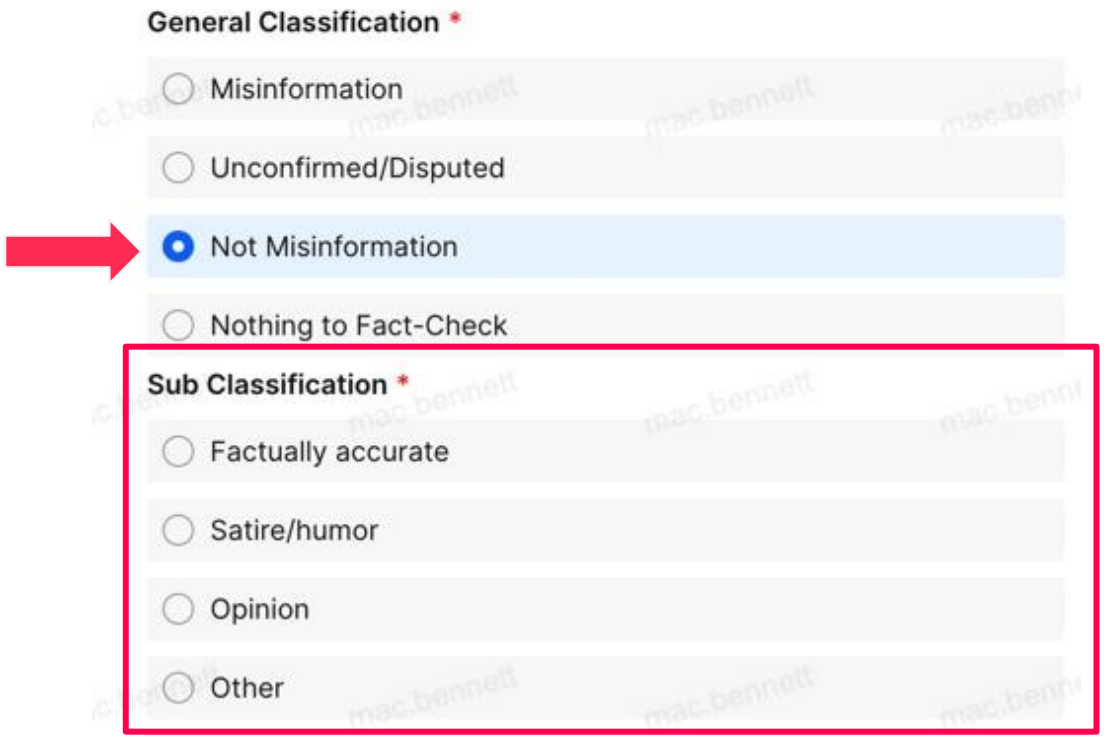


Sub-classifications are multi-select

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Sub-Classifications

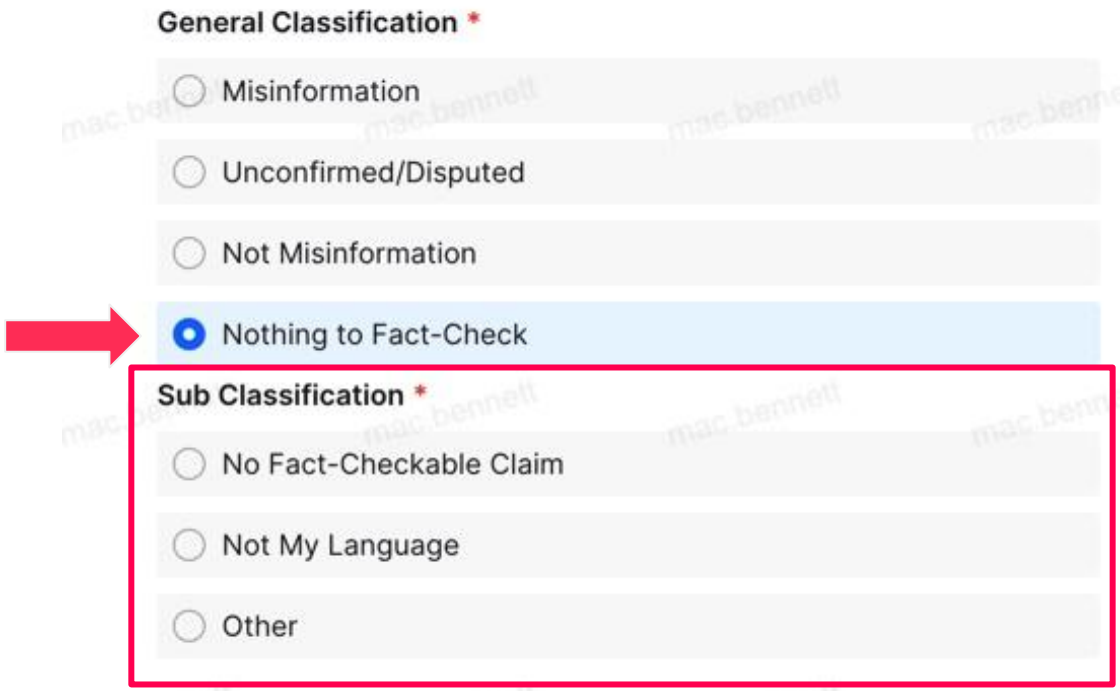
New



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Sub-Classifications

New



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Indicating Harm Type

**Harm Type field will only appear if "Misinformation" or "Unconfirmed/Disputed" Categories are selected*



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Indicating Top/Known/New Claim

**Claim Type field will only appear if "Misinformation" or "Unconfirmed/Disputed" Categories are selected*



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Misinformation Claim

VIDEO INFO

Caption	test text test text test text test text test text test t ext test text test text test text test text test text tex
Create Time	test text test text
VV	0
Share	0

Claim in the Video

Enter a sentence explaining the claim in the video that you are debunking. For example: '5G is harmful to humans' or 'Vaccines cause autism'

Notes

Explain the reasoning for why you chose the categories on the right

URL

Include any links that support your decision



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Instructions for Writing Claim in Video

1. State in 1-3 sentences what the video is asserting/claiming. Focus on the claim itself

2. Structure sentence to clearly identify both the claim's associated subject and key action or characteristic. eg. *"X country did Y"* or *"X medication contains Y"*

3. Write the claim in English. If that's not possible, use the relevant market language (generally, this would be the language in the content)

Examples:

1. *The US is hiding biological weapons research in Ukraine as a part of the "Nimble Elder Program."*
2. *GlaxoSmithKline pharmaceutical company owns Pfizer and the Wuhan Institute of Virology, insinuating the company created the Covid-19 virus and its vaccine for financial gain*

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Notes

VIDEO INFO

Caption	test text test text test text test text test text test t ext test text test text test text test text test tex
Create Time	test text test text
VV	0
Share	0

Claim in the Video

Enter a sentence explaining the claim in the video that you are debunking. For example: '5G is harmful to humans' or 'Vaccines cause autism'

Notes

Explain the reasoning for why you chose the categories on the right

URL

Include any links that support your decision



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Instructions for Writing Notes

1. Explain in a few sentences why the claim is misinformation, unconfirmed/disputed, or not misinformation

2. If there is evidence that supports why the information is true or false, concisely explain why the research you have reviewed and provided supports the category you selected

3. In instances when a claim lacks supporting evidence, but is too vague, new, or niche to be directly debunked by an authoritative source, state that as such. This also applies to videos that rely solely on an anecdotal perspective (i.e. one individual's experience)

- *Example: "As there is no evidence that President Biden is secretly a "Nazi Space Robot," this claim is misinformation."*

4. Write notes in the relevant market language (generally this would be the language in the content. If unclear, use English.

- *Example: "The Nimble Elder Program is a DoD program intended to locate and track chemical and biological weapons to reduce risk. There is not evidence that it is a weapons program.*
- *Example: "The article provided explains that GlaxoSmithKline does not own Pfizer or the Wuhan Institute"*

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Instructions for how not to write Claim in Video & Notes

1. No need to re-state the rating category or classification selected (i.e. Misinformation, COVID-19 Misinformation)

2. Don’t simply state that the content is true or false - Explain why the evidence supports the category (Misinformation/Unconfirmed/Not Misinformation) selected for the content

3. Generally, don't write more than 5-6 sentences. Conciseness is preferred

4. Don’t include links in the Claim or Notes section. Add link URLs in the "URL" field on the left

5. Don’t editorialize - keep notes straight forward and stick to the facts

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URL

VIDEO INFO

Caption	test text test text test text test tex t test text test text test text test te xt test text test text test tex
Create Time	test text test text
VV	0
Share	0

Misinformation Claim

Fill in this field is mandatory

Notes

Fill in this field is mandatory

URL

Fill in this field is mandatory



General Classification *

- Misinformation
- Unconfirmed/Disputed
- Not Misinformation
- Nothing to Fact-Check

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Deep Dive: Categories

General Classification:			
Misinformation (must be verifiably false)	**Unconfirmed/Disputed**	**Not Misinformation**	**Nothing to Fact-Check**
First drop-down category/topic:			
COVID-19 Vaccine	COVID-19 Vaccine	Factually accurate	No fact-checkable claim
Other Vaccine	Other Vaccine	Satire/humor	Not my language
COVID-19	COVID-19	Opinion	Other
Other Medical	Other Medical	Other	
Crisis	Crisis		
Election	Election		
Political	Political		
Edited Media	Edited Media		
Climate	Climate		
Dangerous Conspiracy Theories (a conspiracy theory that casts blame on a named, living individual or a protected group, or denies a violent tragedy, or includes a call to violent action. This includes conspiracy theories created or spread by QAnon.)	Dangerous Conspiracy Theories (a conspiracy theory that casts blame on a named, living individual or a protected group, or denies a violent tragedy, or includes a call to violent action. This includes conspiracy theories created or spread by QAnon.)		
Financial	Financial		
General Conspiracy Theory (a conspiracy theory that casts blame on a group of people OR an organization, government or nation state.)	General Conspiracy Theory (a conspiracy theory that casts blame on a group of people OR an organization, government or nation state.)		
Other	Other		

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Deep Dive: Categories

Misinformation - Must be verifiably false or verifiably misleading
Unconfirmed/Disputed - Unverifiable information about a current and unfolding event where the facts are still developing and/or are not yet confirmed, but we expect that they will be confirmed eventually by authoritative sources
Not Misinformation - Information that is not verifiably false or verifiably misleading. It could mean that there is no reason to believe that the information is false or misleading, factually accurate, or represents humor, satire, or opinion
Nothing to Fact-Check: Content that either has no fact-checkable claim or is in a language that your staff does not review for TikTok

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Deep Dive: Sub-Classifications

Misinformation - Must be verifiably false or verifiably misleading
COVID-19 Vaccine: False or potentially false information related to Covid-19 vaccines and booster shots
Other Vaccine: False or potentially false information related to vaccines (excludes Covid-19 vaccines)
COVID-19: False or potentially false information related to Covid-19, SARS-CoV-2 or any associated Covid-19 variant (excludes covid-19 vaccines)
Other Medical: False or potentially false medical information related to deadly condition, illnesses or diseases to include how they are spread, where they originated, or how to cure/treat/prevent against them OR severely harmful treatments for any non-deadly condition, illness or disease.
Crisis: False or potentially false information related to an ongoing crisis, attack, disaster and/or unfolding event, including content that repurposes old videos, falsely claims or implies that the event or video is new, and is likely to trigger societal panic (such as misleadingly re-purposing footage of bombs or armed attacks out of context)
Election: False or potentially false information related to participation in an election or other civic process, the voting process, or the results of an election. For example, when to, where to, how to or who can vote
Political: False or potentially false information about politicians, a political party, or a campaign or a general political theme or issue that is being debated as part of campaign or election (for example, immigration reform)

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Deep Dive: Sub-Classifications

Misinformation - Must be verifiably false or verifiably misleading
Edited Media: Content that has been doctored or spliced and would or could mislead a reasonable person about the truth of events, including content created or modified using artificial intelligence or deep learning technology. For example, videos spliced together from varying origins/sources, videos that rearrange the chronology of an event to create a new narrative, and videos that change characteristics of the playback elements (for example slowing down the video) to skew the reality of events
Climate: False or potentially false information that contradicts or distorts expert consensus as to scientific evidence about climate change, including that the planet is warming as a result of human activity, climate change will lead to significant instability and damage to the environment, or we can make changes now to reverse future climate change outcomes
Dangerous Conspiracy Theory: A conspiracy theory that casts blame on a named, living individual or a protected group, or denies a violent tragedy, or includes a call to violent action. This includes conspiracy theories created or spread by QAnon
Financial: False or potentially false information related to the stock market, investments or get rich quick schemes, including multi-level marketing schemes
General Conspiracy Theory: A conspiracy theory that casts blame on a group of people OR an organization, government, or nation state
Other: *Select 'other' only when none of the other classifications capture the main theme in the content. In the Notes section, please clarify the topic of the content.*

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Deep Dive: Sub-Classifications

Not Misinformation
Factually Accurate: The claim(s) in the video is (are) accurate and true
Satire/Humor: The video may contain false or misleading information, but a reasonable person would not believe the false or misleading information because it is clearly satirical
Opinion: The content is framed as an opinion that is supported by underlying facts that are verifiably true. If the content is framed as an opinion but contains a claim that is verifiably false, it is still misinformation
Other: *Select 'Other' only when none of the other classifications capture why the video is not misinformation. In the Notes section, please clarify why the video is not misinformation*

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Deep Dive: Sub-Classifications

Nothing to Fact-Check
No fact-checkable claim: No fact-based claim is present or the content cannot be fact-checked because it is narrowly focused on an individual's eyewitness account or experience of an event
Not My Language: The video is not in a language you understand and/or a language in which you review videos for TikTok
Other: *Select 'other' only when none of the other classifications capture why there is nothing to fact-check. In the Notes section, please clarify why there is nothing to fact-check in the video.*

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Deep Dive: Principles behind our harm definitions

When assessing the level of harm, consider the **total potential harm** which consists of the following factors:

1. The **probability** that any harm will occur
2. The **magnitude** of the harm, should it occur, which includes:
    a. The **severity** of the likely harm, and
    b. The **vulnerability** of the target and/or audience of the harmful content (e.g., target is a protected group)
3. Also consider the **context** of the content in the video (e.g. high risk or crisis event such as an election, conflict environment or natural disaster).

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Deep Dive: Selecting Harm

High Harm - Content is likely to cause, or has a history of leading to, high magnitude harm (as measured by severity and vulnerability of the target and/or audience). High harm content is likely to cause:

- Severe physical harm to an individual or community including death, serious physical injury, or serious illness;
- Severe psychological harm to an individual or community including severe impairment to cognitive or mental state, or psychological trauma;
- Widespread societal panic;
- Widespread doubt or distrust in civic institutions and processes, such as governments, elections, and scientific bodies;
- Widespread property damage.

Moderate Harm - Content may cause moderately severe harm. The content doesn't meet the high harm threshold but may cause moderate physical, psychologically, societal, institutional, or reputational harm including:

- Moderate physical harm (short of severe physical harm);
- Moderate psychological harm (short of severe impairment to cognitive or mental state, or psychological trauma);
- Societal, institutional or reputational harm (e.g., deceptive content that can unduly influence public opinion on matters of public concern, accusations of misconduct against a public figure);
- Limited property damage

Low Harm - Content in video is unlikely to cause high or moderate physical, psychological, societal, institutional or reputational harm, and/or content is satirical, humorous or opinion.

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How TikTok Uses Harm Assessment

1. When combined with all of the information provided, the harm assessment will help TikTok moderators and policy teams determine how to address the content

2. For example, content identified as both Misinformation and High harm is more likely to be removed from the platform or removed from recommendation feeds

3. Selecting Low harm doesn't necessarily mean that TikTok will decide not to take action on the content. We will always use this information as one data point in addition to the categories, sub-classifications, and context about the content

4. We view these harm definitions as a pilot that are likely to be iterated on as we go

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How To: Indicate Top Claim

Top Claim

Definition: Included in the Top Misinfo Claims Database *(link to database provided)*

Example(s): Bill Gates created COVID-19; COVID-19 vaccines will kill you; Tom Hanks is part of the Illuminati; Hillary Clinton is harvesting adrenochrome from children

Known Claim

Definition: A debunked claim previously observed on Tiktok not included in the Top Misinfo Claims Database

Example(s): Pfizer CEO Albert Bourla did not receive the COVID-19 vaccine because he believes it can kill you; You can avoid US income taxes by declaring to the IRS that you are not a US citizen

New Claim

Definition: A claim that your team first observed on Tiktok within the past 3-4 weeks. We consider a claim new if it's substantively different from known misinformation, such that an individual aware of previous claims might still be uncertain of the new claim's veracity

Example(s): Trends relating to an event that occurred within the previous month - Accusations the Travis Scott Astroworld concert featured human sacrifice or a doctored video of a political figure's recent speech; Trends relating to new medical treatments - Drinking urine as a cure for Covid-19; Entirely novel/original conspiracies

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Top Claims Database

- TikTok will share with fact-checkers a link to the database (in a spreadsheet) to share with your staff. It is a compilation of previously debunked claims by fact-checkers. ***This database is confidential within our partnership.***

Theme	Mis/Dis Claim
COVID Conspiracy Theories	COVID was created by the government(s) to control/track population
	COVID was man-made/created/planned by Bill Gates or another named person or entity
	COVID was man-made/created/planned by any government/an unnamed individual/group; COVID is a "plandemic"
	COVID was made in/escaped from a lab/the Wuhan lab
Existence or Severity of COVID	Covid pandemic is a hoax/scam; COVID is a "scamdemic"
	Covid pandemic is exaggerated
	Nobody has died from COVID/COVID deaths are exaggerated
COVID Transmission and Immunity	Covid cannot be spread by asymptomatic carriers
	COVID cannot be transmitted in certain climates, weather conditions or locations
	Physical/social distancing does not help to reduce the spread of COVID
	A certain group/race is immune from COVID
COVID Tests	COVID can be tested without an approved test
	COVID tests are pre-infected and can lead to COVID infection
	COVID tests cannot accurately detect COVID
	COVID tests cause cancer or other illnesses
	COVID tests contain harmful nano-particles or nano-worms
	COVID tests contain microchips

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How To: Indicate Known Claim

Top Claim

Definition: Included in the Top Misinfo Claims Database

Example(s): Bill Gates created COVID-19; COVID-19 vaccines will kill you; Tom Hanks is part of the Illuminati; Hillary Clinton is harvesting adrenochrome from children

Known Claim

Definition: A debunked claim previously observed on Tiktok not included in the Top Misinfo Claims Database

Example(s): Pfizer CEO Albert Bourla did not receive the COVID-19 vaccine because he believes it can kill you; You can avoid US income taxes by declaring to the IRS that you are not a US citizen

New Claim

Definition: A claim that your team first observed on Tiktok within the past 3-4 weeks. We consider a claim new if it's substantively different from known misinformation, such that an individual aware of previous claims might still be uncertain of the new claim's veracity

Example(s): Trends relating to an event that occurred within the previous month - Accusations the Travis Scott Astroworld concert featured human sacrifice or a doctored video of a political figure's recent speech; Trends relating to new medical treatments - Drinking urine as a cure for Covid-19; Entirely novel/original conspiracies

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How TikTok Uses Claim Information

- TikTok will use this information to gather data on what claims are sent to our fact-checking partners and train our systems on previously debunked claims

- Tracking Known & New claims will help TikTok identify claims we should consider adding to our Top Misinfo Claims database and train our teams about

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Remember!

Press Submit when you are finished fact-checking a video!



Will resolve task and end the session

Will resolve task and automatically pull a new task.

How to Use Highlight Tool to Review Video Segments

1. **Select “Display Claim”:** TikTok moderators will use the “highlight tool” to select segments of the video that they believe may contain misinformation and request fact-checking partners to assess. When fact-checking partners open a video in TCS, they will see one or more highlighted “claims” to review. Click “Display Claim” and the video will fast forward to the relevant video segment.

2. **Review video segment(s):** Watch each highlighted video segment and complete the accompanying “Claim”, “Notes” & “URL” field.

3. **Submit:** After conducting your reporting and completing all relevant fields, submit.

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Highlight Tool

claim 1

Claim

Enter a sentence explaining the claim in the video that you are debunking. For example: '5G is harmful to humans' or 'Vaccines cause autism'

Notes

Explain the reasoning for why you chose the categories on the right

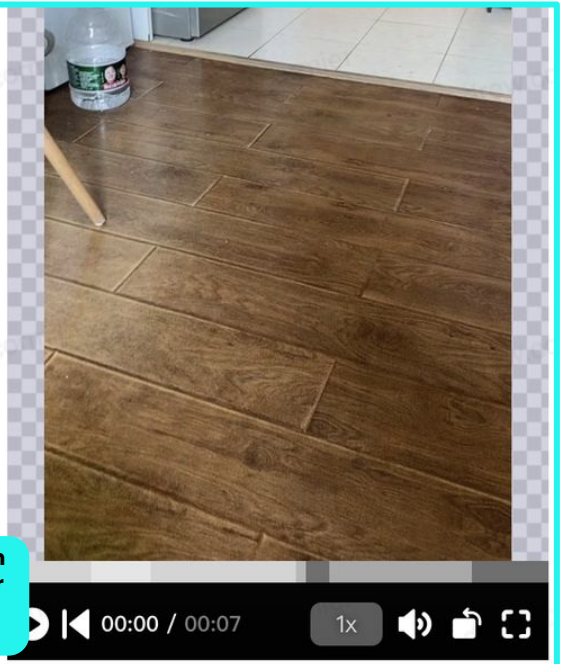
URL

Include any links that support your decision

Click arrow to open and close fields for highlighted segments

claim 2

claim 3



Highlight Duration: 6.751843999999999s

display claim 1

display claim 2

display claim 3

Click here to watch highlighted video segment #1

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More Detailed Instructions for Highlight Tool

- **Videos with multiple highlighted claims**
  - Moderators may highlight multiple video segments
  - A maximum of 180 seconds will be highlighted in each video, regardless of the total video length
  - If some of the highlighted claims are misinformation and others aren't, **only** complete the "Claim", "Notes", and "URL" fields for those that are misinformation. Don't enter the claim, notes, and URL fields for non-misinformation claims.

- **Reviewing non-highlighted video segments**
  - We recognize that your reporters may need to review segments of the video that aren't highlighted to contextualize segments that are highlighted. We encourage you to focus review time on highlighted segments, but you will still be able to review the entire video when needed.

- **Rating videos that include a mixture of misinformation and non-misinformation**
  - Select the *rating*, *classifications*, *harm type*, and *claim type* based on the most misleading/potentially harmful highlighted segment

Thank You!

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